

Cauliflower Information Pack

Introduction

Our cauliflower this week is from **Broadstairs farm** on the **Isle of Thanet in Kent**. The farm is in its fourth generation, being founded in 1955 by the **Bones family**. Cauliflower are a member of the **brassica family** alongside kale and cabbage. **Nutritionally** cauli is low-calorie and high-fibre. It's an excellent source of vitamin C, vitamin K, and folate, supporting immunity, bone health, and cell function. It also contains choline (not chlorine!), important for metabolism and brain health, and its phytonutrients (phyto = plant) such as glucosinolates and isothiocyanates are anti-inflammatory.

Farm Information

These growers deploy many of the same tactics that organic farmers use to control weeds and pests while boosting soil fertility. A three-crop rotation of wheat, beans and cauliflower is used to give the soil a rest and break pest cycles. The beans in this rotation **fix nitrogen** into the soil reducing the need to apply synthetic chemical fertilizer to the land.

Cover crops are also planted over winter to ensure living roots are in the ground all year around, thus supporting soil life and preventing soil erosion (this is one of the key principles of Regenerative farming fyi). Furthermore, they have a strong policy that all crop residue is left in the ground post-harvest. This is important to maintain some kind of habitat for the animals that have grow accustomed to living in the crop, especially ground nesting birds and small mammals.

These growers are gems, lots of videos and farm visits available upon request.

